

Thesis & Evidence

Study Guide - Extended Response

1. Learning goal

Write a clear evaluative thesis and choose evidence that directly supports each reason in that thesis.

2. What this skill means

A useful ER thesis names the better-supported source and previews why. Evidence should then match those reasons exactly. If your reason is productivity, use productivity evidence; if your reason is credibility, use evidence about methods, limitations, or source fit.

3. Do not confuse it with

A thesis is not "Both sources discuss..." and it is not "I agree with...". Evidence is not any interesting fact; it is the fact that performs the job your paragraph claims it performs.

4. How GED-style questions may ask it

You may need to choose the best thesis, select the most relevant evidence, or revise a claim that overstates what a source proves.

5. Repeatable method

- Name the stronger source.
- Give one or two evidence-based reasons.
- Keep the source's qualifiers and scope.
- For each body reason, select one or two specific evidence items.
- Reject evidence that is true but measures a different outcome.

6. Worked example

A pilot reports 12 percent more completed projects and 78 percent schedule preference.

Question: Which evidence supports productivity?

Reasoning: The 12 percent project increase measures work output. The 78 percent figure measures preference, a different claim.

Best answer: Use the project-completion statistic for productivity.

7. Common traps

- Writing a topic statement instead of an evaluative thesis.
- Using proves, always, or everyone when the source is limited.
- Using preference evidence to prove performance.
- Adding outside evidence not supplied in the task.

8. Diagnostic help

- If your thesis could fit any topic, make the reasons more specific.
- If evidence feels impressive but does not match the paragraph claim, replace it.
- If your sentence makes the source more certain than the original, restore words such as may, some, or suggests.

9. Quick check

A source reports that missed appointments fell during a text-reminder pilot but notes that scheduling also changed.

Write one precise thesis reason.

Check yourself: The source has measured appointment data and acknowledges another possible cause, which makes its support more careful.